Companion — Presentation Commander Client user guide

This is a Bitfocus Companion connection module for the Presentation Commander Client, the app that runs on the presentation laptop. It drives slides, sections, Program Out, the laser pointer and PowerPoint media playback from a Stream Deck, across every source type the Client supports: PDF, Keynote, PowerPoint, Google Slides and Canva.

> **This is not the module for the Master Server.** Its sibling, companion-module-presentationcommander-server, controls the separate Master Server over that server's own HTTP automation API (routing, scenes, blackout and stage notes). This one is for the Client Node on the presentation laptop. Most rigs want both, as two connections.
>
> **This module was built with AI assistance and reviewed by a human.** Check it over before you rely on it for a show.

Setting it up

1. Install the module. It isn't in the official store, so you have to point Companion at it:

```
git clone https://github.com/stoatworks-labs/companion-module-presentation-commander-client
cd companion-module-presentation-commander-client
npm install
```

In Companion, go to **Settings → Developer modules path** and point it at **the parent folder that contains this repo's folder**, not at the folder itself. Restart Companion, or use "Rescan for developer modules" if your version has it, and "Presentation Commander Client" turns up as a connection you can install.

2. Turn OSC on in the app. In the Client, click **Start OSC** in the titlebar. Once you've started it once, it remembers across restarts.

3. Add the connection, and set three fields:

Field	Default	What it is
App host	`127.0.0.1`	The machine running the Client Node. The default assumes Companion is on the same machine.
App listen port	`35551`	Where the Client listens. Matches its own default.
Local feedback port	`35550`	Where this module listens for the Client's replies. Matches its own default.

If Companion and the Client are on different machines (and on an actual rig they usually are, since the Client lives on the presentation laptop), change **App host** to the laptop's IP, *and* set the Client's own OSC **Feedback host** to the Companion machine's IP rather than `127.0.0.1`. Miss that second half and every button works while every variable stays empty.

Actions

Slides

Action	What it does
Next slide / Previous slide	Step through the deck
Go to slide number	Jump to an absolute slide
Go to first slide / Go to last slide	Ends of the deck

Sections

Action	What it does
Go to first slide of section	Jump to a named section
Go to first slide of next section	Skip forward a section
Go to first slide of previous section	Skip back a section

The named-section action gives you **a live dropdown of whatever the Client last reported**, plus a custom value that takes variables, for when you want it to change on the fly.

Program Out

Action	What it does
Start Program Out from first slide	Open the output at the top of the deck
Start Program Out from current slide	Open it where you already are
Close Program Out	Shut the output
Toggle black screen / Toggle white screen	Cover the output
Toggle laser pointer overlay	Show/hide the pointer
Set current slide as desktop wallpaper	For a holding image behind the output

Auto-advance

Action	What it does
Pause auto-advance / Resume auto-advance	Hold and release a timed run

Media — PowerPoint on Windows only

Action	What it does
Media: play	Start embedded media
Media: pause	Pause it
Media: toggle play/pause	One-button transport
Media: stop	Stop it

> These four only work **for PowerPoint on Windows**, and **only when the presenter has a live PowerPoint slideshow running separately from the app**. On any other source, or on macOS, they do nothing.

Protocol control

Action	What it does
Enable / Disable OSC actions	Turn remote control off from the surface
Enable / Disable OSC feedback	Turn the Client's replies off
Request feedback refresh	Ask the Client to re-send everything
Set watched folder	Point the Client at a different folder
Request watched-folder file list	Refresh the file dropdown
Open file from watched folder	Load a deck by name

Feedbacks

Two:

- **Slideshow state:** edit / running / running-with-auto-advance-paused.
- **OSC file access enabled**.

There are three things you might expect and won't find, all for the same reason: the protocol doesn't carry the data, so a feedback would have to make it up.

- **No laser-pointer-on or auto-advance-enabled feedback.** Only the combined edit/running/paused state is broadcast.
- **No media playing/paused/stopped feedback.** The Client's media control only ever sends a duration, because PowerPoint's COM object model has no way to report playback state.
- **No `sourceKind` variable.** The Client keeps track internally of whether the current deck is PDF, Keynote, PowerPoint, Slides or Canva (it uses that to decide which features apply), but it never sends it.

Variables

Variable	Contents
`presentationName`	Presentation / file name
`filePath`	Full path to the open file
`slideCount`	Total slide count
`slideCountVisible`	Total slide count, excluding hidden slides
`state`	Presentation state (edit / running / paused)
`currentSlide`	Current slide number
`slidesRemaining`	Slides left in the deck
`notes`	Current slide's notes
`sectionIndex`	Current section index
`sectionName`	Current section name
`sectionSlidesRemaining`	Slides remaining in the current section
`previousSectionName`	Previous section name — "Start of deck" if this is the first
`previousSectionFirstSlide`	First slide of the previous section
`nextSectionName`	Next section name — "End of deck" if this is the last
`nextSectionFirstSlide`	First slide of the next section
`mediaDuration`	Media duration in seconds
`mediaDurationFormatted`	The same, as mm:ss
`fileAccessEnabled`	Whether OSC file-open access is enabled
`activeFolder`	Watched folder, relative to the home directory
`activeFolderFullPath`	Watched folder, full path
`activeFolderFileCount`	Number of files in the watched folder
`activeFolderFileNames`	JSON array of file names in the watched folder

`notes` is the one worth building a surface around: a big text button showing `$(<connection-label>:notes)` turns any Stream Deck into a confidence monitor (a small one, but still). The prefix is whatever you called the connection in Companion.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause
Module doesn't appear in Companion	The developer modules path points at the repo folder rather than **its parent**.
Buttons work, all variables empty	Feedback isn't getting back. The Client's **Feedback host** must be the Companion machine's IP, not `127.0.0.1`.
Nothing happens at all	OSC isn't started in the Client, or App host / App listen port is wrong.
Media buttons do nothing	Not PowerPoint, not Windows, or no independently-running PowerPoint slideshow.
Section dropdown is empty or stale	The list is whatever the Client last reported. Fire **Request feedback refresh**.
File-open action does nothing	File access is disabled in the Client; check the `fileAccessEnabled` variable.
I want routing / scenes / blackout	Wrong module — that is the Server one.

See also

- README: what it does, installing it, and the prior art I looked at for how to structure the module
- presentation-commander-client: the app this controls, and its OSC protocol
- companion-module-presentationcommander-server: the sibling module for the Master Server